Participant Handout

CPPUG Power Platform Hackathon

CPPUG means Calgary Power Platform User Group. This handout covers the schedule, the rules, and how teams are scored.

Schedule

Time	What happens
9:00 AM	Doors open and check-in
9:30 to 9:55 AM	Welcome, rules, and challenge briefing
10:00 AM	Build time starts
12:30 PM	Lunch (provided). You can eat at your table and keep building.
1:45 to 2:00 PM	Stop feature work. Hand in your team summary. Set up your demo.
2:00 to 3:15 PM	Team demos
3:15 to 3:40 PM	Judges score. Everyone else networks.
3:40 to 4:00 PM	Awards, photos, and closing

How the day works

- **Teams.** Teams have 2 to 3 people. No team? Organizers match you with other builders.
- **Challenge.** Pick a prepared challenge or bring your own idea. Prepared challenges: Inventory Management, Time Off Management, Inspection System, Expense Tracking, Room or Equipment Booking, and Employee Kudos. Open Build lets you pick any idea where Power Platform is central. The Challenge Case Studies sheet describes each one.
- **Plan first.** Spend your first 30 minutes on the idea, not the build. Pick the problem, list your options, and sketch the screens on paper or a whiteboard. Judges look for this work.
- **Goal.** Build a minimum viable product (MVP). An MVP is a simple version that works. Aim for a small solution that works, not a large one that does not.
- **Prizes.** Two individual Power Platform Community Conference 2026 (PPCC26) passes, provided by Microsoft. A pass covers the conference only. Travel and accommodation are not included. At check-in, tell organizers if you could travel and book within the next few days. Judges pick the two people from that list, starting with the top-scoring teams. Runners-up receive Lego Clippy mascots.

Rules

- **Register and bring a laptop and charger.** You may use your own Power Platform environment if your organization allows it.
- **Use Power Platform and build during the event.** Power Platform must be a main part of the build. Do the main build work between 10:00 AM and 1:45 PM.
- **Use any help you like.** Documentation, Microsoft Learn, search, and AI tools are allowed. Tell the judges what you used.
- **No finished solutions.** Do not enter a complete solution that you built before the event. Reusable snippets and patterns are fine if you can say what you built during the event.
- **Be respectful.** Respect participants, organizers, volunteers, judges, and Microsoft staff. Harassment, discrimination, and intimidation are not allowed. Organizers may remove anyone who creates an unsafe or hostile space.

What to hand in by 1:45 PM

Give the demo organizer a short team summary. Judges score your demo against it.

Field	What to write

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Problem	One sentence. What problem does the solution solve, and for whom?
How we chose it	One sentence. Why this idea? Which other ideas did you weigh?
Plan	What did you sketch or write before building? Show it in your demo.
Core features	Up to 3 features. Judges check these in the demo.
Power Platform parts	List each part you used (for example, Power Apps, Power Automate, Dataverse).
Team	Team name and member names.

Your demo

Slots: 15 minutes (10 demo, 5 questions) for up to 5 teams, 10 minutes (7 + 3) for 6 to 7 teams, and 7 minutes (5 + 2) for 8 to 10 teams. Organizers confirm yours at the opening. Slides are optional. Cover 4 parts: (1) the problem you solved and who it helps, (2) a live demo, (3) the Power Platform parts you used and why, (4) what your team learned. Show your sketch or plan for about 30 seconds. A phone photo of it works.

How you are scored

Each judge scores each team on 4 criteria with a whole number from 1 to 5. Each score turns into points. The most points possible is 100 (30 + 35 + 25 + 10).

Functionality (30%, score x 6 points)

Does the solution do what the team said it would do? Judges compare the live demo with the core features listed in the team summary.

Score	What the judge sees
5	All listed core features work live. No errors. The team also shows one edge case handled well (for example, an empty field or a wrong entry).
4	All listed core features work live. One small glitch at most.
3	Most listed core features work live (for example, 2 of 3). Some bugs.
2	Fewer than half of the listed core features work live (for example, 1 of 3). The team needs workarounds.
1	No core feature works live, or the demo fails.

Effective use of Power Platform (35%, score x 7 points)

Did the team pick the right Power Platform parts and use them well? Judges count only what the demo shows working. Parts are Power Apps, Power Automate, Power BI, Power Pages, Copilot Studio, AI Builder, a data store (Dataverse or SharePoint list), and connectors (such as Outlook or Teams).

Score	What the judge sees
5	3 or more parts work together as one solution. The team explains why they chose each part. At least one platform strength is used (for example, approvals, shared data, a connector, or AI).
4	3 or more parts work together and each one fits the problem.
3	2 parts, and both fit the problem (for example, an app plus a flow).
2	1 part with basic use only, or 2 parts where one does not fit.
1	No Power Platform part is central, or the tools do not fit the problem.

Design and user experience (25%, score x 5 points)

Did the team think before they built, and is the result easy to use? Judges count how many of these 5 items the team shows: (A) Idea: how they chose it, such as the user need or the options they weighed. (B) Plan: a sketch, wireframe, mock-up, or flow diagram made before building. Paper, a whiteboard photo, sticky notes, and the Whiteboard app all count. (C) Match: the built screens follow the plan, and the team says what changed and why. (D) Use: a new user could finish the main task with no explanation. (E) Polish: the layout is consistent and the text is easy to read.

Score	What the judge sees
5	All 5 items shown (A, B, C, D, E).
4	4 of the 5 items shown.
3	3 of the 5 items shown.
2	2 of the 5 items shown.
1	1 item shown, or none.

Presentation quality (10%, score x 2 points)

Did the team cover the 4 required parts? The parts are: (1) the problem and who it helps, (2) a live demo of the solution, (3) the Power Platform parts used, (4) what the team learned.

Score	What the judge sees
5	All 4 parts covered, inside the time limit, and the team answers questions clearly.
4	All 4 parts covered, inside the time limit. Answers to questions are adequate.
3	3 of the 4 parts covered.
2	2 of the 4 parts covered, or the team cannot answer most questions.
1	1 part or none covered.

Winners. Judges score alone and compare your demo with your team summary. Organizers average the totals. The two highest averages are the winning teams. Tie: higher Effective use points win, then higher Functionality points, then the judges decide.